ACT III: METHOD

Grant's Gala Briefing

PRIVATE GALA BRIEFING / TRANSCRIPT

Before anyone calls this gift settled, check the unsigned papers. Artie will lose the donation rather than skip the board vote.

The family gets a board seat only after acceptance. They already want the appointment while I'm alive. Sue has stopped my public announcement. The private toast can go ahead.

The bowl is off the market. The historic bottle stays on loan. Vincent won't let me print his painting. I can withhold his last payment.

PROGRAM COORDINATOR / RETAINED DONOR REPLY

No live stunt involving me or any guest. Submit screen version only.

SCREEN VERSION: ALSO REJECTED

ANNOUNCEMENT DESK / RETAINED ORIGINAL

Master: UNSIGNED / WITHDRAWN. Public copy held by coordinator. Separate private copy held by Grant.

ACCOUNTS / UNRESOLVED GALA PAYMENTS

Gala settlement attachments

Elon: camera connection	Invoice REJECTED: connection not installed.
Staff wages	Paid from restricted funds without approval.
Gala fabric	Paid from another client’s commission advance.
Sculpture	Resin + metal powder. Label corrected; final payment reduced.
Family appraisal	Condition: INTACT. Comparison used: DAMAGED object.
Sale endorsement	Withdrawal received BEFORE public announcement.
School places	Workshop funds used. Paid weekend session CANCELED.

SURFACE EXAMINATION / RETAINED SCULPTURE SAMPLE

Bronze powder and gold leaf. No red foil-backed paper.

ACT III: METHOD

The Registrar's Working File

BOTTLE / RECEIVING COPY

The purchase requires original contents, not an empty bottle or replica. Seller confirms contents retained; no cancellation or substitution received. Received before gala: closed bottle, dealer’s note, complete seller terms. Loan caption: “Contents inert.”

OCTOBER 29, 2026 / STAFF PROOF / DR. ART E. FACT TO INTAKE

Seller requires original contents. Lender calls contents inert. Please clarify before opening.

Intake reply: Unresolved. Keep closed.

OUTGOING COPIES / Staff: full query, seller attachment, restriction. Press: Reed DeLabel’s marked caption.

Press proof: Contents inert. ~~Purchase condition requires original contents to remain.~~

CLOSURE TREATMENT / RETAINED COPIES

Red paper fitted across stopper

SIGNED ORIGINAL	CHIP’S INSURANCE COPY
October 30, 2026	**October 29, 2026**

COLLECTION OFFICE / FILE CHECKS

Cupboard lock, after preview	Staff keys: OPEN. Founder’s spare: OPEN.
Bowl label correction	“Ownership settled” WITHDRAWN. Supporting papers missing.
Ownership file	Claimants’ letter + earlier acquisition advice. No ministry return order enclosed.
Lender descriptions	Old rule: publish before supporting papers arrive. Revised rule: review papers first.
Press correction	Correction concerns the former owner’s name only. No claim of poison treatment.

The Press Desk Originals

PAIGE TURNER / UNTRIMMED RECORDER

SERVICE MANAGER: Mr. Larceny, I'll leave your glass here. I'm going back to the kitchen about that added course.

GRANT: Thank you. Paige, I asked for a quiet private place. Why have you followed me here?

PAIGE: You agreed to an interview about the gift. It's on the recorder.

GRANT: It's the gala. I'm announcing the gift tonight. Ask about that, or we'll speak tomorrow.

ROBIN: Grant, here is your copy. The museum already has one. Return the bowl intact or give the claimants a hearing.

GRANT: This is my private room, Robin, not the public podium. I'm already answering the reporter. I am not reading a petition here.

PRODUCTION COPY / RECEIVED BEFORE GALA



Original sound: “Jacket take” → chair scrape → clatter. Picture and sound received together. Podcast master: same sequence. Teaser starts after “Jacket take.”

PICTURE EDITOR / CARD RECEIPT

Copied complete card after preview, before returning it. Import: physical bottle on open stand; no toast photograph. Photographer’s agency export supplied later.

Agency correction: earlier gallery photo was commercial, supplied as news. Public podium visible; disputed purchase cropped out.

INSTALLATION / COMPLETED CHANGES

Grant’s place setting	Proposed transparent cover CANCELED on BOTH styling copies.
Bottle stand	Proposed glass front NOT INSTALLED.
Textile projection	Magnified stitches only.
Alcove	Hanging load REMOVED; route CLOSED.

Docent: “We returned to the public cases. We never entered Grant’s room or stopped at his place.”